

STYLE GUIDE

The Related Work Journal

One ink, one pen, white paper. How the journal looks.

EDITION OF OCTOBER 2026 · RELATEDWORK.BLOG

01

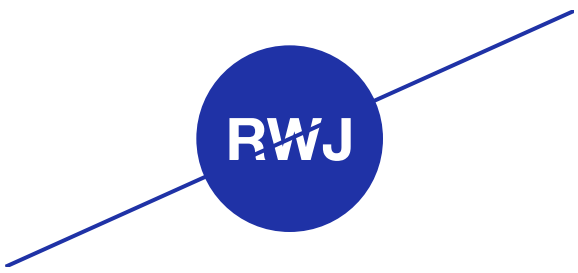
The idea

The journal is printed by a pen plotter in one ink on white paper. Every letter is a round pen run along Dr. A. V. Hershey's 1967 plotter strokes; every picture is printed in the same ink. Nothing on the page is there to decorate it.

RULES

1. One ink: ballpoint blue. A second color appears only as a kind of post (a letter, a frame), never as decoration.
2. Titles are drawn, on one line, never wrapped and never clipped. A long title is condensed before it is made smaller.
3. No rules between posts. Space separates; a month name marks where the month changes.
4. No reading time. A post is title, blurb, date, then the post.
5. Pictures print in the ink; their true color comes up when you point at them.
6. Likes and comments are small drawn signs at the end of a post, not buttons.
7. Nothing that reads as 2014 tech: no flat square buttons, no gray cards, no sans-serif headlines.

NEVER



The mark set in a typeface



The mark with a shadow



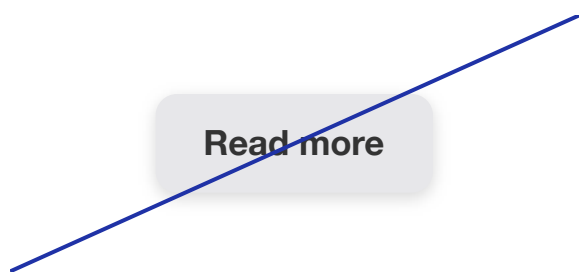
The mark in another color



A title on two lines



A sans-serif headline



A gray card or button

02

Writing

Every word in the journal is the writer's own. The Studio checks spelling, grammar and usage and suggests; it never writes.

TITLES

Written as the writer means them; the page draws them, it never changes them. Two kinds have a fixed form:

Dear Friend:

A letter is titled "Dear …:", with the colon.

1: A Shark Who (Maybe) Knew Shakespeare.

A post of links is numbered, with a colon after the number.

BLURBS

One sentence under the title, in italic. It is also the description Bear sends with the post, so it shows in search results, links and the email.

Apple sidestepped the magic of the new iPhone Duo by focusing on boring uses for it.

SPELLING AND DATES

American spelling: color, realize. Dates as the site prints them: 8 Sep 2026; a month on its own in full, September 2026.

USAGE

The Studio's usage guide is the Sepper Manual of Style, after Garner's method: it marks only what is rejected or avoided in standard English, never a superstition, and never touches a quotation. "That's my voice" quiets a rule for good.

03

The mark

A full stop with RWJ drawn through it in paper. The full stop is used on the home page; the ring, on every post.



The full stop

Home page, favicon, avatar, share image.



The ring

Beside the nameplate on every post.

SIZES

58 px on a desktop, 42 px on a phone, beside the nameplate. The favicon is drawn with a thicker pen so RWJ still reads at 16 px.



SPACE

Keep clear a quarter of the mark's width on every side. The nameplate sits 16 px away (12 px on a phone).

ELSEWHERE

Share image: the full stop at 62% of a 1200 x 1200 white square (rwj-share.png). Avatar: the full stop alone, cropped to its circle. Favicon: the full stop at 16, 32 and 180 px.



The Related Work Journal

The nameplate: the full name, plotted, one line, beside the mark.

04

Color

One ink on one paper. The ink is ballpoint blue; everything quieter is the same ink, thinner.

Aa

Paper
#FFFFFF
the page

Aa

Ink
#1F32A6
every letter, line and picture

Aa

Pale ink
74%
dates, labels, captions

Aa

Faint ink
18%
selection, hairlines

A LETTER

Posts written as letters ("Dear …:") are typed in blue-violet on peach-pink paper, after the letters page of *Eros*.

Aa

Letter paper
#FDD9D3
a letter's page

Aa

Letter ink
#3F2FA6
a letter's type

FRAMES

A framed post sets its title inside a heavy frame in one Risograph ink, chosen when the post is published. These are the only other colors.

Black
#000000

Federal Blue
#3D5588

Teal
#00838A

Green
#00A95C

Fluorescent Pink
#FF48B0

Purple
#765BA7

Sunflower
#FFB511

Orange
#FF6C2F

05 Lettering

No ordinary typeface. Titles are plotted live, stroke by stroke; what you read is RWJ Plotter, a webfont made from the same strokes with a round pen.

TITLE, A POST — DRAWN · UP TO 168 PX · ONE LINE

1: A Shark Who (Maybe) Knew Shakespeare.

TITLE, THE LIST — DRAWN · UP TO 104 PX

iPhone Duo

BLURB — RWJ PLOTTER ITALIC · 23 / 34

Apple sidestepped the magic of the new iPhone Duo by focusing on boring uses for it.

READING — RWJ PLOTTER · 20 / 33 DESKTOP, 18 / 30 PHONE

What they've seen, living to 500 years old, is impossible to comprehend and fascinating.

LABELS — RWJ PLOTTER · 13 / 16 · CAPITALS SPACED .14 EM · PALE INK

SEPTEMBER 2026 · 20 SEP 2026 · NOTES · SUBSCRIBE

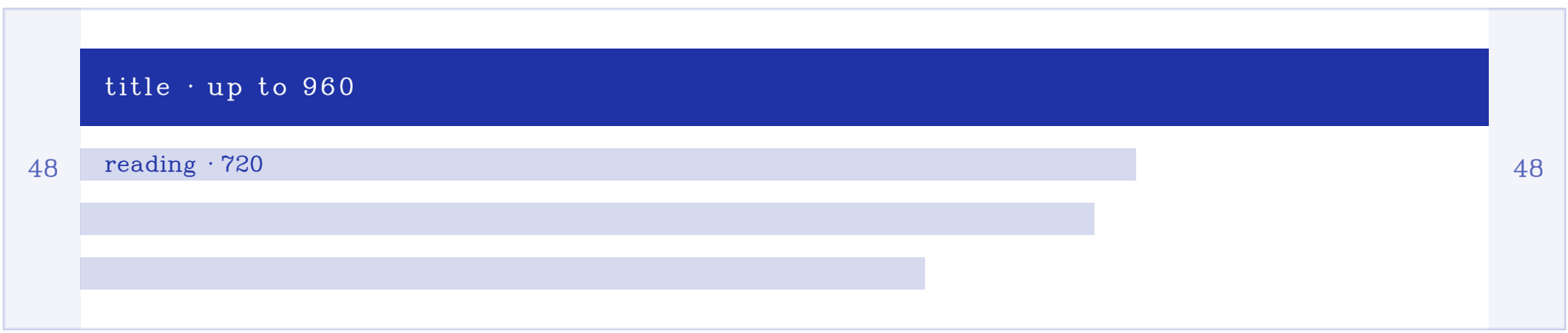
A LETTER — RWJ PLOTTER MONO BOLD · 24 / 28

You were cooking. I came over.

06

The page

One left edge for everything. What you read keeps to 720 px; a title may run on to 960 px. The margins are 48 px on a desktop and 20 px on a phone.



THE LIST

Title, then the blurb 16 px under its baseline, then the date 8 px under the blurb. 72 px between posts; a month name 120 px above, 40 below. The whole entry is the link; pointing at it, the pen presses harder on its title.

A POST

Title, blurb 28 px under it, the date 14 px under that, then 48 px to the first line. Paragraphs 18 px apart. Notes are numbers in the text: a card above on a desktop, a sheet from the foot on a phone, and all of them again at the end.

THE END

A short 32 px pen stroke, then the like and comment signs, then the comments: one line to write in, the thread under it, replies indented 24 px.

SEPTEMBER 2026

NEW

iPhone Duo

Apple sidestepped the magic of the new iPhone Duo.

9 SEP 2026

07

Kinds of post

Three kinds, chosen in the Studio when a post is published. The kind changes the head of the post, never the reading.

PLAIN

iPhone Duo

9 SEP 2026

The default. The title drawn on the page's left edge.

LETTER

Dear Friend:

What was I hoping for? You were cooking. I came over.

Titled "Dear …:". Typed, set big and close, on peach paper.

FRAMED

Why Blog?

The title quiet in a heavy frame of one riso ink.

PICTURES



Every picture prints in the ink, as a duotone: shadows in the blue, lights in the paper. Point at it (or scroll past it on a phone) and the true color fades up through the print. A picture can be marked "true color" to skip the print.

Captions in the label style, under the picture. Pictures in a list run the full width.

SIGNS

like comments NEW the latest post 1 a note

08

Files

brand/rwj-dot.svg · rwj-dot-1024/512/180/32/16.png · rwj-dot.ico	The full stop: home, favicon, avatar
brand/rwj-ring.svg · rwj-ring-1024/512/180/32/16.png	The ring: posts
brand/rwj-share.png	The share image, 1200 x 1200
out/media/261003-rwjplotter-text / italic / mono / monob.woff2	RWJ Plotter, the reading face
tools/plotter/ (strokes.json, mkfont.py, Hershey license)	The strokes, and how the font is made
site/plotted.css · site/plotted.js	The live design, published from the Studio (Publish styles)

Hershey fonts: created by Dr. A. V. Hershey at the U.S. National Bureau of Standards; used under the Hershey license, with acknowledgment.

COLORS, TO COPY

--rwj-paper	#FFFFFF	--rwj-ink	#1F32A6
--rwj-pale	rgba(31, 50, 166, .74)	--rwj-faint	rgba(31, 50, 166, .18)
letter paper	#FDD9D3	letter ink	#3F2FA6
black	#000000	federal blue	#3D5588
teal	#00838A	green	#00A95C
fluorescent pink	#FF48B0	purple	#765BA7
sunflower	#FFB511	orange	#FF6C2F

A

After dark

PROPOSED · NOT LIVE

At night the paper and the ink trade places: the ballpoint blue becomes the paper and the lettering is drawn in white, like a cyanotype. It follows the reader's own dark setting; there is no switch on the page.

BY DAY

iPhone Duo

Apple sidestepped the magic of the new iPhone Duo.

AT NIGHT

iPhone Duo

Apple sidestepped the magic of the new iPhone Duo.

Aa

Night paper

#162A6B

the page, Prussian blue

Aa

Night ink

#F5F3ED

lettering; running text

#E9E5DA

Aa

Night letter

#2C1D6B

a letter's sheet; type

#FDD9D3

Aa

Picture shadow

#0C1A4D

a step deeper than the paper

LABELS

Dates and labels in the night ink at 86%; selection and hairlines at 26%.

FRAMES

Black, federal blue and purple frames are drawn in the page white; the bright riso inks stay.

PICTURES

Print as by day. Shadows go a step deeper than the paper so a picture keeps its edge; lights stop at 92%.